

MSci Projects 2026–2027

Literature Review and Research Proposal 2026

As part of the preparation for your final-year MSci research project next year, you are required to write a literature review and research proposal. This should be up to 10 pages in length, and should comprise approximately eight pages of a review of the chemical literature in the research area of your project and two pages focusing on your project proposal.

Please note that whilst passing this component of your programme is a requirement to progress to your final year, there is no associated mark which counts towards your final degree total.

The overarching aim of the literature review/research proposal is to help you prepare for your project work next year by initiating your reading around your research. Please note that the review is not expected to be a comprehensive summary of all the chemistry related to your project. Rather, it's an opportunity ahead of starting project work in October for you to begin to become familiar with your area of research by writing about the key ideas, concepts and current thinking in the field. The assignment provides you also with an opportunity to produce a piece of scientific writing in preparation for producing your project dissertation next spring.

You should engage with your research supervisor to discuss your project, and you should continue to interact with them as you draft your submission. For many of you next year's project will be your first taste of chemistry research, and until now most of you won't have experienced planning a research project. Your supervisor will guide you in defining the project and formulating the research plan and proposal and will provide suggestions and constructive feedback as you draft your literature review.

You should submit your piece of work by **noon BST on Friday 19 June 2026** via a dedicated Blackboard portal. The portal will be set up so that you may make multiple submissions until the deadline, such that you have the opportunity to check that no formatting issues have occurred with your submission. Also, the Blackboard portal will be set up such that your submission will be assessed for plagiarism via the Turnitin system, but it will not be added to the database. This means when you are preparing your research project report next year you may use your piece of work without fear of self-plagiarism.

Your project supervisor will provide feedback according to the following criteria:

- Literature review coverage
- Insight, analysis and appreciation of context
- Understanding of the project background, aims and objectives
- Quality of the programme plan
- Fall-back options, appreciation of risk and flexibility in planning

This feedback will be provided by **Friday 26 June**.